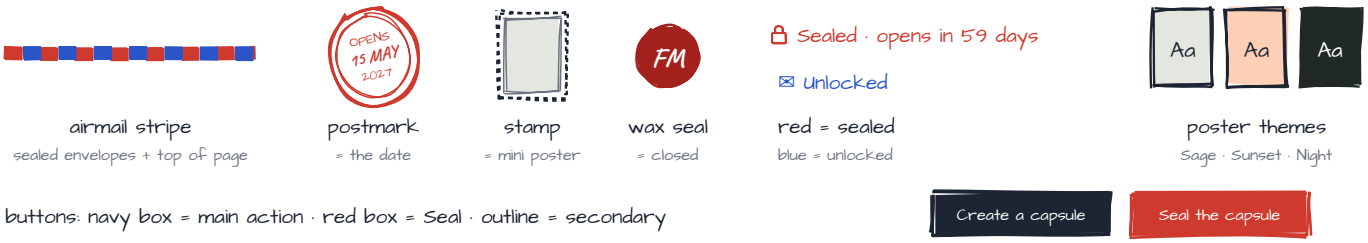
FutureMe — design workflow

Wed, Nov 4 2026 · Ibrahim (ia2629) · Amit (asb2332) · Sammy (sn3136) · Yiyao (yz5137)

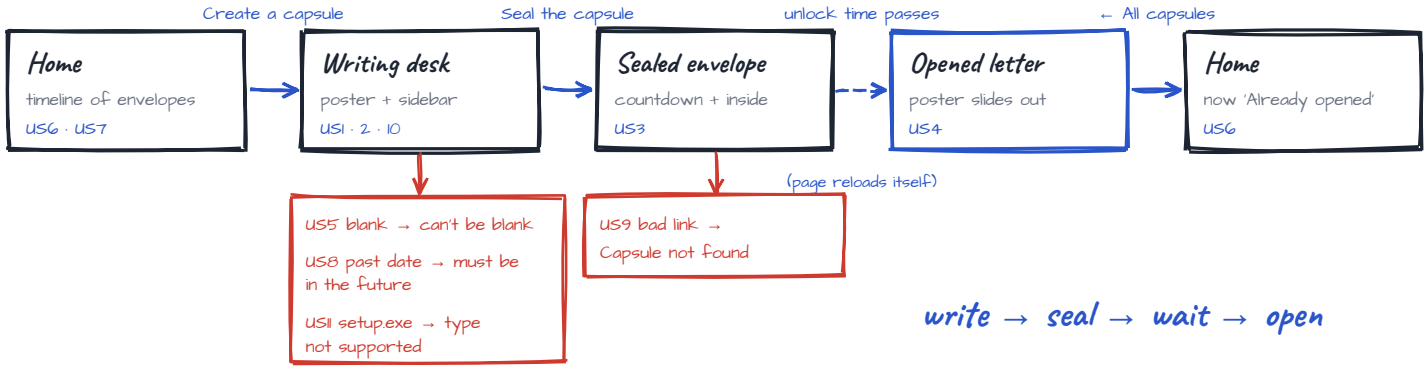
Big idea: every capsule is a letter to the future. You seal an envelope now, and it opens on a date that matters. preserve the moment, share the meaning ♡

design key



the flow

One person, no accounts. Write → seal → wait → open.



screens

A · Home /index.html US6 · US7



1 Hero = one tilted airmail envelope. You get what a capsule is before reading anything.

keep → "Create a capsule"

2 Timeline, soonest first. Sealed = airmail border + red dot. Opened ones move down to "Already opened" with a blue dot. Each card: number, title, status, what's inside, postmark with the date on top of a stamp of the poster.

keep → card links contain the title · "Opening soon" · "Already opened" · "Sealed" · "Unlocked"

3 Empty state: dashed card with a wax seal, one sentence and the Create button. (US7)

keep → "No capsules yet"

B · Writing desk /create.html US1 · US2 · US5 · US8 · US10 · US11



1. Poster on a darker "desk", locked to 4:5, same shape as the capsule page so nothing jumps after sealing. Photos = tilted prints. Voice notes = pill with play, waveform, length.

   keep → aria-labels "Title", "Message", "Text block 1"...

2. **01 Stationery**: three "Aa" theme swatches, then theme, colors, font, icon.

   keep → select "Theme" (has "Night") · input "Icon"

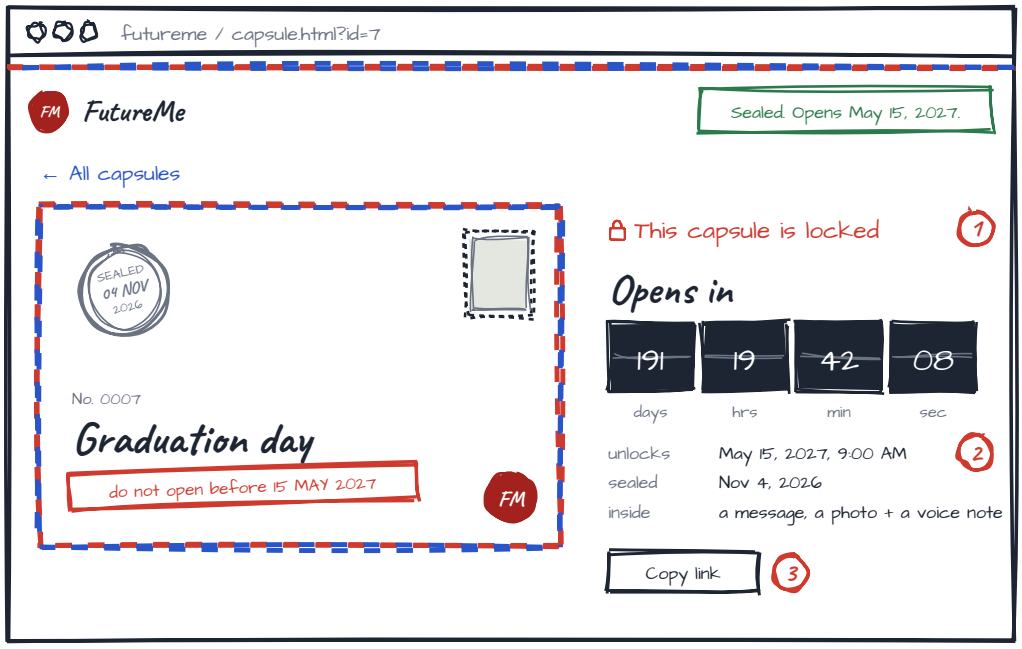
3. **02 Contents**: every block listed, lock on the sealed ones, click to select. Add text / photo / audio. Errors right under the buttons. Max 25 MB.

   keep → "Add text" · "Add photo" · "Add audio" · "Photo 1" · "Voice note 1"

4. **03 Delivery**: unlock time, +1 mo / +1 yr / +5 yr, errors one per line, red seal button last.

   keep → "Unlock at" · "Seal the capsule" · every error word for word

C · Sealed envelope /capsule.html?id=7 US3



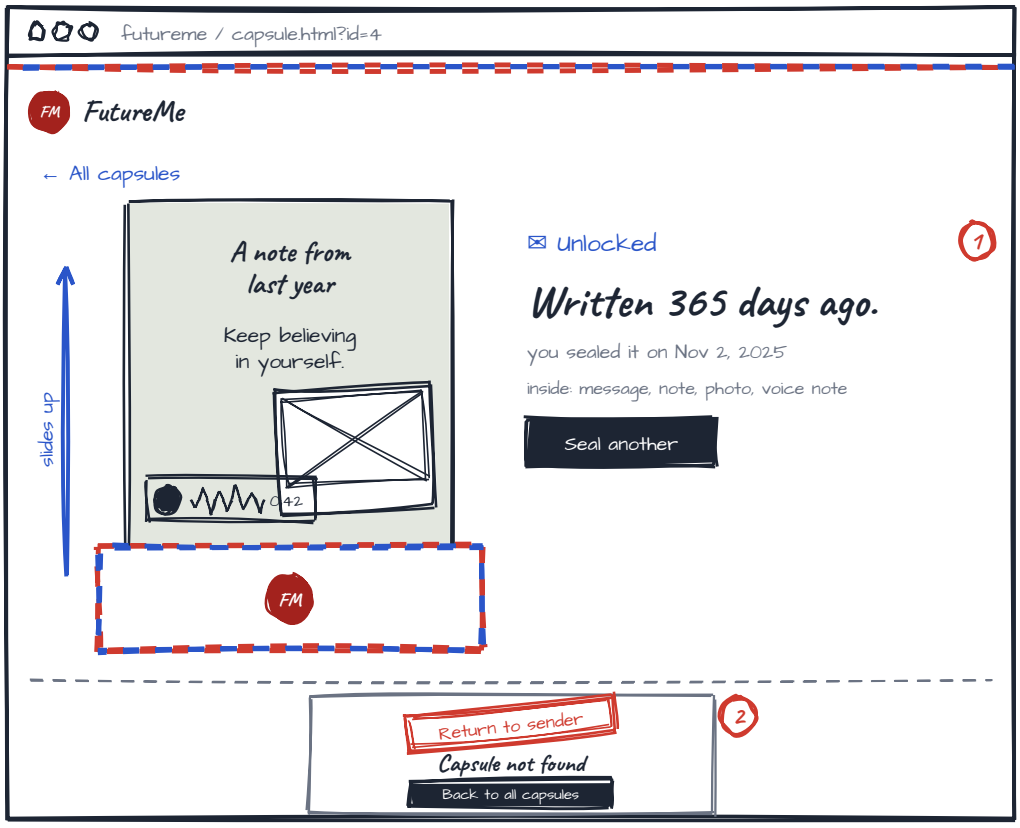
1. Show the envelope, not the poster. Title, stamp and postmark are public. Message, photos, voice notes are not on the page at all.

   keep → "This capsule is locked" in normal case, NO css uppercase (Selenium reads the uppercase text → test fails)

2. Dark flip-board countdown, then the dates and an "Inside" line that says what's sealed without showing it.

3. Copy link (optional, US13). No accounts, so the URL is how you share.

D · Opened letter & E · Not found /capsule.html?id=4 US4 · US9



1 On arrival the poster slides up out of the envelope pocket, then the pocket drops away. Photo + voice note come out with it; waveform lights up while playing. Skip the animation if reduced motion is on.

keep → message is in the page from the start → old "unlocked" scenario still passes

2 Bad link → "Return to sender" stamp + a way back home.

keep → "Capsule not found"

user stories

blue = happy path · red = sad path · grey = optional, only if we build it

1. As **someone preserving a memory**, I want to write a titled message and choose an unlock time so that it's revealed at the right moment.

   ✓ passing

2. As a **creator**, I want to choose a theme, font and icon and arrange blocks on the poster so that it feels personal, like picking stationery.

   ✓ passing

3. As a **visitor to a sealed capsule**, I want to see its envelope (title, stamp, countdown, what's inside) but not the contents, so that I can look forward to it without spoilers.

   ✓ passing

4. As a **visitor after the unlock time**, I want to read the message and see every photo and voice note so that I can revisit everything that was sealed.

   ✓ passing

5. As a **creator**, I want clear errors when I leave out the title, message or unlock time so that I know what to fix.

   ✓ passing

6. As a **returning user**, I want my capsules on a timeline, split into "Opening soon" and "Already opened" and sorted by date, so that I can see what's coming next.

   + new scenario

7. As a **first-time visitor**, I want an empty state that points me to create a capsule so that I know where to start.

   + new scenario

8. As a **creator**, I want a past unlock time rejected so that every capsule actually waits.

   + new scenario

9. As a **visitor with a broken link**, I want a clear "Capsule not found" page so that I can get back to my capsules.

   + new scenario

10. As a **creator**, I want to add photos and voice notes anywhere on the poster, sealed with the message, so that the capsule holds more than text.

    + new scenarios

11. As a **creator**, I want unsupported or oversized files rejected with a clear message so that I can fix my upload.

    + Cucumber (type) & RSpec (25 MB)

12. As a **creator**, I want "+1 month / +1 year / +5 years" shortcuts so that picking a far-off date is quick.

    optional

13. As a **sender**, I want to copy a capsule's link so that I can share it without accounts.

    optional

cucumber scenarios

features/capsules.feature · first five are already in the repo, unchanged

Create a future capsule US1

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I fill in "Title" with "Graduation day"
And I fill in "Message" with "I am proud of how far you have come."
And I fill in "Unlock at" with a date one day from now
And I create the capsule
Then I see "Graduation day"
And I see "This capsule is locked"

Create a customized poster capsule US2

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I choose "Night" from "Theme"
And I fill in "Icon" with "✦"
And I add a text block
And I fill in "Text block 1" with "Private poster note"
And I fill in "Title" with "My custom poster"
And I fill in "Message" with "A message for later"
And I fill in "Unlock at" with a date one day from now
And I create the capsule
Then I see "My custom poster"
And I do not see "Private poster note"
And the poster design is saved

View a locked capsule US3

Given a capsule titled "Birthday wishes" unlocks tomorrow with the message "Happy birthday from all of us!"
When I visit FutureMe
And I open "Birthday wishes"
Then I see "Birthday wishes"
And I see "This capsule is locked"
And I do not see "Happy birthday from all of us!"

View an unlocked capsule US4

Given a capsule titled "A note from last year" unlocked yesterday with the message "Keep believing in yourself."
When I visit FutureMe
And I open "A note from last year"
Then I see "A note from last year"
And I see "Keep believing in yourself."

Reject an invalid capsule US5

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I create the capsule
Then I see "Title can't be blank"
And I see "Message can't be blank"
And I see "Unlock at can't be blank"

See capsules on the timeline US6 · new

Given a capsule titled "Birthday wishes" unlocks tomorrow with the message "Happy birthday!"
And a capsule titled "A note from last year" unlocked yesterday with the message "Keep going."
When I visit FutureMe
Then I see "Opening soon"
And I see "Already opened"
And I see "Sealed"
And I see "Unlocked"

Empty home page US7 · new

When I visit FutureMe
Then I see "No capsules yet"

Reject an unlock time in the past US8 · new

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I fill in "Title" with "Too late"
And I fill in "Message" with "Oops"
And I fill in "Unlock at" with a date one day ago
And I create the capsule
Then I see "Unlock at must be in the future"

Open a capsule that doesn't exist US9 · new

@allow-rescue

When I visit the capsule page for id "999999"
Then I see "Capsule not found"

Add a photo and a voice note US10 · new

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I attach "grad.jpg" with "Add photo"
And I attach "voice_note.m4a" with "Add audio"
Then I see "Photo 1"
And I see "Voice note 1"

Media stays hidden while sealed US10 · new

Given a capsule titled "Grad day" with a photo unlocks tomorrow
When I visit FutureMe
And I open "Grad day"
Then I see "a photo"
And I do not see a photo on the poster

Media appears after unlock US4 · US10 · new

Given a capsule titled "Last year" with a photo unlocked yesterday
When I visit FutureMe
And I open "Last year"
Then I see a photo on the poster

Reject an unsupported file US11 · new

When I visit FutureMe
And I visit the new capsule page
And I attach "setup.exe" with "Add photo"
Then I see "File type not supported"

coverage

US1, 2	create · custom theme, icon, private text
US3, 4	locked view · unlocked view · media after unlock · media hidden while sealed
US5, 8	blank fields · past unlock time
US6, 7	timeline sections + status · empty home
US9	unknown capsule id
US10, 11	photo + voice note · bad file type (cuke) · over 25 MB (rspec)